LAW & JUDICIARY | Constitutional Democracy

JUSTICE FOR ALL: The endeavour and the gap

KIREN RIJIJU *Union Minister of Law and Justice of India*

DRAWING THE LINE

Never one to mince words, Union law minister Kiren Rijiju displayed the same spirit in his 33-minute session at the India Today Conclave. He denied there was any confrontation with the judiciary, only differences of opinion. On the key question of judicial appointments, he was categorical it was an administrative function that was the government's preserve, and defended its right to reserve information on why judges' names are withheld. The collegium system, however, he said, would continue till a new system is introduced.

The minister's harshest comments, though, were reserved for Rahul Gandhi and the "*tukde tukde*" gang. Both, he asserted, speak the same language. He was firm that he would not allow them to destroy India's integrity and sovereignty. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The government has been clear from day one in giving space to judiciary, maintaining its independence as well as strengthening it
- Everyone is accountable; Parliament runs under rules. But courts have no rules, only conventions
- It's the governmet's duty to do due dilgence on names it is sent; it is not just a postmaster
- EC appointment is prescribed in the Constitution. Parliament has to enact law



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